

TryHackMe Writeup: Search Skills

Room: information gathering, search engines and cybersecurity research

Objective: Learn how to find technical information, investigate internet-facing systems, research vulnerabilities, and use specialized search services. The room introduces resources such as Shodan and technical documentation.

Step 1 - Understand cybersecurity research

In cybersecurity, searching efficiently helps you:

- Identify software versions and known vulnerabilities.
- Research suspicious domains, IP addresses, and files.
- Find official documentation and security advisories.
- Investigate indicators of compromise (IOCs).

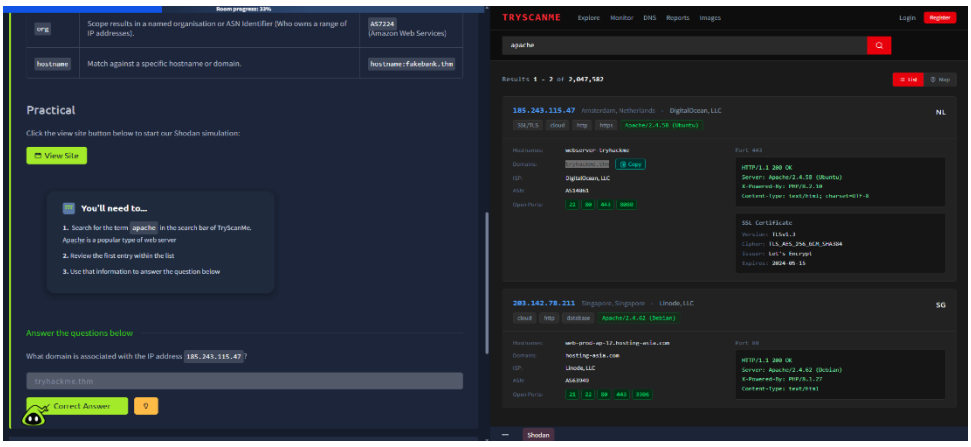
Start the room and read the introductory task.

Step 2 - Explore Shodan

Website: Shodan

Shodan indexes information about internet-connected devices and the services they expose.

1. Open Shodan.



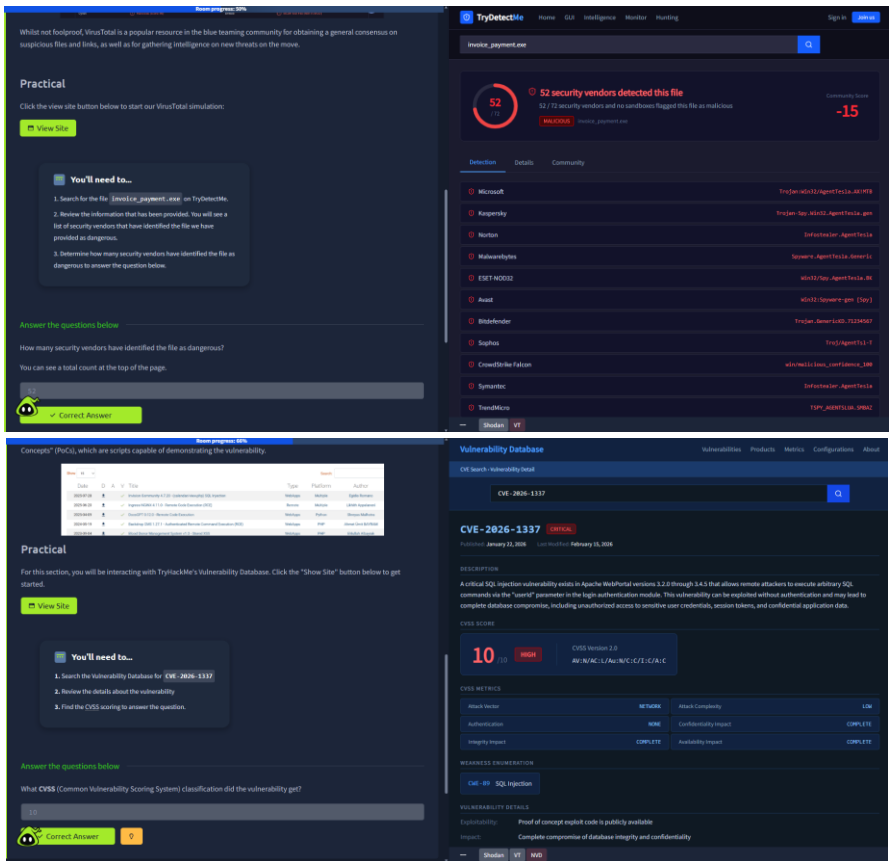
2. Search for a technology or service, such as Apache.
3. Examine results for service banners, ports, software versions, and geographic or organizational metadata.
4. Read the room's example and answer the related questions.

Key concept: A service banner may reveal a product or version, but it does not automatically prove that the service is vulnerable.

Step 3 - Research vulnerabilities

Use reliable vulnerability resources:

- NVD - vulnerability records and CVE information.
- CVE - identifiers for publicly disclosed vulnerabilities.
- Exploit-DB - published exploit research.
- Official vendor documentation - configuration and patch information.

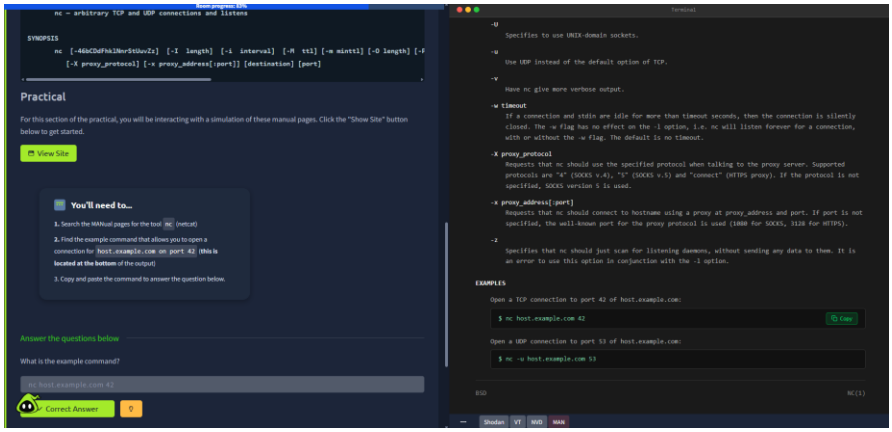


Practice by looking up a software product, identifying a version, and checking whether an advisory applies to that version.

Step 4 - Technical Documentation / MAN

1. Open the simulated manual-page viewer.
2. Search for nc (netcat).
3. Read the example at the bottom showing how to connect to host.example.com on port 42.

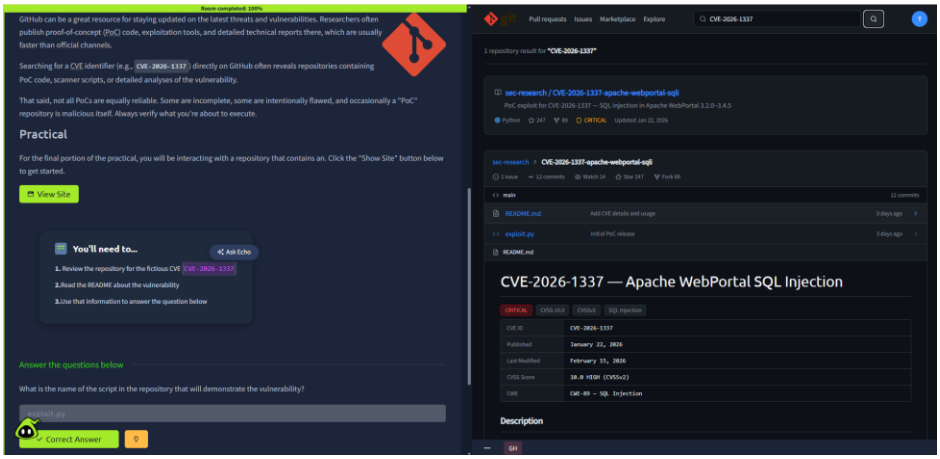
Search engines support operators that narrow results.



Use these operators to find relevant documentation instead of relying on broad searches.

Step 5 - GitHub

1. Open the room's simulated repository for CVE-2026-1337.
2. Read the repository's README.
3. Identify the script named as demonstrating the vulnerability.
4. Do not execute untrusted code just because it is hosted on GitHub



Step 6 - Complete the room questions

1. Open each linked research service mentioned in the task.
2. Repeat the demonstrated search.
3. Inspect the result and identify the information the question requests.
4. Submit your answer in the room.
5. Record the search operator or research resource that helped you.

What you should learn: Search engines, Shodan, vulnerability databases, and vendor documentation serve different purposes. Choosing the right source is a core cybersecurity skill.